



Product Requirements Document

Version 1.0 - May 2026 - Phase 1: MVP

Product Owner	Status	Last Updated	Phase
Filipa Martins	Draft - v1.0	May 2026	1 - MVP

Scope: This PRD covers Phase 1 (MVP) of ELO - the Lisbon launch, targeting months 1-6. Phases 2 and 3 are referenced for context but are not scoped in detail here.

1. Executive Summary

ELO is a free, government-backed mobile application that connects adults aged 65+ in Portugal with local events, community groups, and volunteer opportunities. It addresses a documented public health crisis - chronic loneliness among older adults - through a calm, focused digital platform with no ads, no opinions, and no noise.

The MVP targets Lisbon, launches within months 1-6, and aims to reach 500 monthly engaged community members with a 14-screen app built around two core user archetypes. Government partnership is the primary distribution and credibility mechanism. The north star metric is Monthly Engaged Community Members - not passive users, but people who actively participate.

500	3-5	14
Active users	Gov partnerships	Screens in MVP
Phase 1 target	Phase 1 target	App scope

2. Problem Statement

2.1 The Context

Portugal is ageing faster than anyone is responding. A quarter of the population is already over 65 - approximately 2.6 million people. By 2050, this rises to 34.5%. The ratio of older adults to young people, currently 192 to 100, is projected to reach 300 to 100 by 2080 (INE, Ageing Index 2025).

2.2 The Health Crisis

67% of people aged 65+ in Portugal report loneliness as a sustained condition (Mira et al., European Geriatric Medicine, 2025). This is not a lifestyle issue - it is a documented public health emergency.

+26%

Increased premature mortality risk

from social isolation - Holt-Lunstad et al., 2015

+40%

Higher dementia risk

from chronic loneliness - Lancet Commission, 2020

2.3 The Three-Sided Problem

#1	Loneliness & Isolation	67% of Portuguese adults 65+ experience sustained loneliness. The mortality risk is equivalent to smoking 15 cigarettes a day. This is epidemiology, not sentiment.
#2	No Tool Built for Them	Facebook has events and groups, but delivers political noise, fake news, and algorithmic outrage. Research shows users are actively disengaging. There is no calm, focused alternative.
#3	The Discovery Gap	69% of respondents cannot find local activities or rely entirely on word of mouth. Events exist. The problem is not supply - it is connection.

2.4 The Opportunity

61% of adults aged 65–74 in Portugal used the internet in 2024 (INE, ICT Survey 2024). This audience is online and reachable. ELO's own primary research found that 87% of respondents would use or consider a free, easy, relevant app - and 69% don't know where to look for activities.

Research note: Primary research comprised 5 in-depth interviews (ages 62–73) and a survey of 23 respondents conducted in March 2026. This is directional research - the signal is consistent but the sample is not statistically significant.

3. Goals & Success Metrics

3.1 Product Goals

- Connect adults 65+ in Lisbon with local events, community groups, and volunteer opportunities
- Establish ELO as the trusted, calm, government-backed alternative to noisy social platforms
- Validate the self-sustaining community model - users who join as attenders become organisers
- Build the foundation for Phase 2 national expansion

3.2 North Star Metric

Monthly Engaged Community Members (MECM)

A user qualifies as an engaged community member in a given calendar month if they meet at least one of the following:

- Attend at least 1 event
- Interact in at least 1 group (post, comment, or join)
- Exchange at least 1 message with another user

Why not MAU? Monthly Active Users counts anyone who opens the app. Presence is not belonging. MECM measures whether ELO is actually doing what it was built to do.

3.3 Phase 1 Success Criteria

Metric	Target	Timeline	Priority
Monthly Engaged Community Members	500	Month 6	P0
Government partnerships signed	3–5	Month 3	P0
App screens live	14	Month 1	P0
Event RSVP rate (of users who view an event)	≥ 25%	Month 3	P1
User-to-organiser conversion rate	≥ 5%	Month 6	P1
Day-30 retention	≥ 35%	Month 3	P1
App store rating	≥ 4.2	Month 4	P2
Avg. events attended per active user/month	≥ 2	Month 6	P2

4. User Personas

ELO was designed for two primary archetypes identified through qualitative research. These personas are not demographic segments - they are behavioural archetypes that define both the onboarding experience and the product's long-term growth loop.

Maria - The Active Attender	António - The Emerging Organiser
66 • Lisbon • Recently retired • Divorced	70 • Setúbal • Retired accountant • Married
Digital behaviour WhatsApp, Instagram, Facebook, Candy Crush. Knows the basics. Gets frustrated quickly. Closes any app that asks for information before showing value.	Digital behaviour WhatsApp, Facebook, YouTube, Google Maps, Gym app, News app. Self-taught, comfortable exploring. If an app is not intuitive within 2 minutes, he leaves.
Goals Find nearby activities that feel safe and accessible. Meet people naturally, without forced networking. Rebuild structure and purpose post-retirement.	Goals Find purposeful ways to engage with his community. Share professional knowledge. Organise activities around real interests and substance.
Pain points No trusted tool to find local events. Relies on word of mouth. Googled activities once, got overwhelmed, gave up. Won't arrive somewhere alone not knowing anyone. "I want to do things. I just don't know where to start."	Pain points Volunteer opportunities feel too basic. No simple way to organise or post a local activity. Facebook is exhausting - noise, opinions, fake news. "I have energy, experience and time. I want to contribute."

The growth arc: Maria joins as an attender. António joins as an organiser. Over time - because the product is designed for it - Maria becomes António. This attender-to-organiser conversion is the self-sustaining flywheel that drives Phase 1 growth.

5. Design Principles

Every design decision in ELO is a direct response to what was heard in user research. These are not aspirational values - they are binding constraints on all product decisions.

Principle	What it means in practice
Value before friction	No login wall. No gate. Users see real local events the moment they open the app - before we ask for anything. Every interview participant cited login walls as the reason they quit an app. We lose some anonymous-user data. We accepted that trade.
Comfort before design grid	The second screen in the app is a text size selector - Medium, Large, XLarge - before events, before location. User comfort takes precedence over design convention.
Language that respects	ELO never uses the words 'senior', 'elderly', or 'retirement' anywhere in the app or its communications. The app does not know how old you are. It knows what you like.
The anti-Facebook	No opinions. No comment threads. No political content. No algorithmic outrage. When users described what exhausted them about Facebook, they described exactly what ELO is not.
Calm over engagement	ELO does not optimise for time-in-app. It optimises for real-world events attended. Push notifications are limited and purposeful, never manipulative.
Accessibility is not a phase	Text size customisation is in the onboarding, not settings. Voice guidance is scoped for Phase 3, not because it is optional but because it requires resource. Accessibility decisions are never deferred without explicit acknowledgement of the cost.

6. Features & Requirements

The Phase 1 MVP consists of 14 screens covering five functional areas. Features are prioritised using MoSCoW. All P0 features are required for launch.

P0 - Must Have	P1 - Should Have	P2 - Could Have	P3 - Won't Have (Phase 1)
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6.1 Onboarding & Anonymous Browse

Requirement	Acceptance Criteria	Priority
Anonymous browse - users can explore events and see event detail without creating an account	User opens app and reaches event feed within 2 taps. No email, phone, or social login required.	P0
Text size selector - second screen in onboarding, before any other preference	Three options: Medium (16pt), Large (20pt), XLarge (24pt). Selection persists across sessions.	P0
Location permission prompt - after text size, before event feed	Plain language explanation of why location is needed. Graceful fallback to city-level if denied.	P0
Interest category selection - minimum 3 categories required to proceed	Categories include: Walking, Arts & Culture, Music, Volunteering, Gardening, Languages, Board Games, Cooking, History, Sport, Social. Minimum 3 selected before feed populates.	P0
Account creation - available from any point after anonymous browse	Fields: Name (first only), Email, Password. No date of birth. No phone number. No social login required.	P0
Onboarding completion rate tracking	Analytics event fires on each onboarding step completion. Drop-off tracked per step.	P1

6.2 Event Discovery & Feed

Requirement	Acceptance Criteria	Priority
Event feed - personalised by location and interest categories	Default sort: distance (nearest first). Events show: title, date/time, location, distance, attendee count, free/paid badge.	P0
Event detail page - full information before RSVP	Shows: full description, organiser name, location map, attendee count, upcoming dates (if recurring). RSVP available to anonymous users (prompts account creation on tap).	P0
One-tap RSVP - 'I'm going' confirmation	Confirmation screen shows: event name, date, time, user name ('You're going, [Name]'). Not 'registration successful'.	P0
Reminder setting - opt-in at RSVP confirmation	Options: 1 day before, 1 hour before, both, none. Notification requires permission grant.	P0

Requirement	Acceptance Criteria	Priority
Event search - by keyword, category, and distance radius	Filters: category (multi-select), date range, distance (1km, 5km, 10km, any). Search results show same card format as feed.	P0
Map view - toggle between list and map on the event feed	Map pins show event category icon. Tap pin to open event card preview. Tap card to go to event detail.	P1
Save event - bookmark for later without RSVP	Saved events accessible from profile. Not shown to other users.	P1
Recurring event support	Events can be marked as weekly/monthly recurring. Separate RSVP per occurrence.	P2

6.3 Event Creation (Organiser Flow)

Requirement	Acceptance Criteria	Priority
Post an event - available to any registered user	Fields: title, description (max 500 chars), category, date & time, location (address or map pin), max attendees (optional), free/paid toggle. Paid events - price field only. No payment processing in Phase 1.	P0
Event moderation - government partner review queue	Events from non-government-verified organisers enter a review queue. Government partners can approve/reject within 48h. Auto-approve after 48h with no action.	P0
Organiser profile badge - visible on event cards	Verified government partner events show a trust badge. User-created events show no badge.	P0
Event edit - organiser can update event details post-publish	Changes to date/time trigger re-notification to all RSVPd attendees.	P1
Event cancellation - organiser can cancel with reason	Cancellation reason shown to RSVPd attendees via push notification.	P1
Attendance tracking - organiser can see RSVP list	First-name only. Count only shown publicly. Full list visible to organiser only.	P1

6.4 Community Groups

Requirement	Acceptance Criteria	Priority
Group discovery - browse and search groups	Groups shown in feed after event section. Filter by category and distance. Group card shows: name, member count, recent activity.	P0
Join a group - one tap	Members see: group description, upcoming group events, recent posts. Group is public by default.	P0

Requirement	Acceptance Criteria	Priority
Group feed - posts visible to members only	Text posts only in Phase 1. No images, no links. Max 280 characters. No threaded replies - flat comment structure.	P0
Group events - organiser can post events linked to a group	Group events appear in both the group feed and the main event feed.	P1
Create a group - available to any registered user	Fields: name, description, category, location. Requires at least 1 event to be posted within 30 days of creation or group is archived.	P1
Group member directory - first names only	Opt-in. Member can choose to appear or remain anonymous within the group.	P2

6.5 User Profile

Requirement	Acceptance Criteria	Priority
Profile page - personal activity summary	Shows: first name, Explorer badge + event count, groups joined, events hosted. No age, no surname shown publicly.	P0
Explorer badge system - progression visible on profile	Levels: Explorer (1-5 events), Connector (6-15), Navigator (16-30), Organiser (31+). Badge visible on profile only, not on event cards.	P1
Notification preferences - manage from profile	Toggle: event reminders, group activity, new events matching interests. All on by default. Off individually.	P0
Account settings - edit name, email, interests, text size	Password change requires current password confirmation.	P0
Delete account - GDPR-compliant data deletion	Full data deletion within 30 days. Confirmation email sent. Events hosted remain but are anonymised.	P0

7. Out of Scope - Phase 1

The following are explicitly excluded from the Phase 1 MVP. They are documented here to prevent scope creep and to confirm they are planned for Phases 2 and 3.

Excluded from Phase 1	Planned for Phase
Direct messaging between users	Phase 2
Photo or image sharing in groups or events	Phase 2
Push notification system beyond reminders	Phase 2
Calendar integration (Google Calendar, Apple Calendar)	Phase 2
In-app payment processing for paid events	Phase 2
AI-powered event recommendations	Phase 3
Voice guidance / audio navigation	Phase 3
Government health data integration	Phase 3
Multi-city rollout beyond Lisbon	Phase 2
Web app / desktop version	Phase 3
Age verification mechanism	Never - by design
Advertising or sponsored content	Never - by design

8. Key User Stories

The following user stories define the core flows for the Phase 1 MVP. Each is written from the perspective of the primary persona.

8.1 Maria - Attender Journey

#	As Maria, I want to...	So that...	Acceptance Criteria
1	Open the app and immediately see events near me, without creating an account	I can evaluate whether ELO is worth my time before committing	Feed loads within 3 seconds. At least 3 events visible without scroll. No login prompt on first open.
2	Choose how large I want the text to be	I can read comfortably without straining	Text size selector appears on second screen. Selection applies globally and immediately. Persists between sessions.
3	Tap 'I'm going' and see a warm confirmation with my name	I feel like a real person, not a number	Confirmation reads 'You're going, [First name]'. Not 'Registration confirmed'. Visible within 1 tap of event detail.
4	Set a reminder for an event I've RSVP'd to	I don't forget to go	Reminder options appear immediately after RSVP confirmation. Choice of 1 day before, 1 hour before, or both.
5	Find a group of people who share my interests near me	I can belong to a community, not just attend a one-off event	Groups appear in feed below events. Join requires 1 tap. Group feed visible immediately after joining.
6	Post my own event after attending a few	I can give back and become part of the community	'Post an event' available from profile after 3+ events attended. Prompts only - not required.

8.2 António - Organiser Journey

#	As António, I want to...	So that...	Acceptance Criteria
1	Post a local event quickly without needing technical expertise	I can share what I'm organising with people nearby	Event creation is maximum 5 steps. Required fields only: title, date, time, location, category. Live within 48h of submission.
2	See who has RSVP'd to my event	I can plan for the right number of people	RSVP count visible on organiser view. First names only. No personal contact details shared.
3	Edit or cancel my event if plans change	I can manage my commitment to attendees	Edit available from organiser profile. Cancellation requires a reason. All RSVPd users notified automatically.
4	Create a group around my area of expertise	I can build something lasting, not just one event	Group creation available from profile. Linked events appear in group feed and main feed simultaneously.

9. Technical Requirements

Note: ELO Phase 1 is a mobile-first product. The following requirements define the non-negotiable technical constraints for launch.

9.1 Platform & Performance

- Mobile-first: iOS 15+ and Android 10+ required
- Initial load (cold start to event feed): ≤ 3 seconds on 4G connection
- Event feed refresh: ≤ 1.5 seconds
- Offline mode: cached event feed and saved events viewable without connection
- App size: ≤ 50 MB download

9.2 Accessibility

- Text size: system-level and in-app size selection honoured
- Colour contrast: WCAG AA compliant minimum across all screens
- Touch targets: minimum 44×44pt on all interactive elements
- Screen reader: VoiceOver (iOS) and TalkBack (Android) compatible on all P0 screens
- No time-based interactions that cannot be paused or extended

9.3 Privacy & Data

- No date of birth collected at any point
- No age verification mechanism - by design
- Location data: used for proximity calculation only, not stored persistently
- GDPR compliant: full data deletion within 30 days of account deletion request
- Analytics: event-level only, no personal identifiers in analytics payload
- No third-party advertising SDKs
- No data sold or shared with third parties

9.4 Government Partner Integration

- Government partners access a web-based admin panel (separate from the app)
- Partner panel: event moderation queue, event posting, analytics dashboard (aggregate only)
- Partner authentication: email + password + 2FA required
- API: REST API for event data ingestion from partner CMS systems (Phase 1 optional, Phase 2 required)

10. Risks & Mitigations

Risk	Severity	Mitigation	Owner
Cold start problem: no events → no users → no events	High	Secure 3–5 government partner commitments before launch. Partners seed initial event calendar. Launch in spring/summer when outdoor events are naturally higher.	Product / Gov Relations
Government partnership does not materialise before launch	High	Maintain fallback plan: launch with community-curated events and civic organisation partners (libraries, parish councils). Adjust 'government-backed' messaging to 'civic-backed'.	Product Owner
Digital literacy barrier - target users cannot navigate onboarding	Medium	Usability testing with adults 65+ before launch. Onboarding reduced to minimum steps. Anonymous browse means users get value before any friction.	Design / Research
Low organiser adoption - no one posts events	Medium	Prioritise António-type users for early outreach. Government partners seed events. Explorer-to-organiser nudge built into product at 10+ events attended.	Product / Marketing
Younger users join and change the community tone	Low	Content design mitigation: events are local, civic, community-focused. Platform is not interesting to someone not looking for this. No age gate - friction is content, not mechanism.	Product
App store rejection or delayed review	Low	Submit for review 3 weeks before launch date. Prepare contingency for PWA (Progressive Web App) version as fallback.	Engineering
GDPR / data compliance issue	Medium	Legal review of data model before public beta. Privacy by default - no persistent location, no DOB, no third-party ad SDKs.	Legal / Product

11. Roadmap

ELO is built in three phases. This PRD covers Phase 1 in full. Phases 2 and 3 are outlined here for strategic context.

Phase 1 - MVP	Phase 2 - Community	Phase 3 - AI + Gov
<i>Months 1–6</i> - Lisbon launch - 3–5 government partnerships - 500 MECM target - 14-screen app live - North star metric validated	<i>Months 6–12</i> - Porto + 3 more cities - Group admin tools - Push notifications - Calendar integration - Photos in groups - Direct messaging	<i>Months 12–18</i> - National rollout - AI recommendations - Voice guidance - Healthcare pilot - Government data integration - EU funding applications

Commitment: We are not promising Phase 3. We are building Phase 1 in a way that makes Phase 3 possible.

12. Open Questions

The following questions require resolution before or during Phase 1 development. Each is assigned an owner and a target resolution date.

Question	Owner	Target	Status
Which government bodies will be the Phase 1 partners - Câmara Municipal de Lisboa, Junta de Freguesia, or both?	Filipa M.	Month 1	Open
What is the content moderation SLA for government partners - is 48h auto-approve acceptable?	Product + Legal	Month 1	Open
Will ELO be listed on the App Store under the government partner's developer account or ELO's own?	Engineering + Legal	Month 1	Open
What is the fallback event-seeding strategy if government partnerships are delayed beyond Month 2?	Product	Month 2	Open
Are paid events in scope for Phase 1 (display only, no processing), or should they be deferred entirely?	Product	Month 1	Open
What analytics platform will be used, and what is the data retention policy?	Engineering	Month 1	Open
Will the government partner admin panel be built in Phase 1 or will partners use a shared spreadsheet workflow initially?	Engineering	Month 2	Open

13. Appendix

13.1 Research Sources

- ELO Primary Research (2026). *In-depth interviews and survey on loneliness among older adults*. Unpublished internal research, March 2026. Directional only. [5 interviews, 23 respondents]
- Holt-Lunstad, J., Smith, T.B., Baker, M., Harris, T. and Stephenson, J. (2015). Loneliness and social isolation as risk factors for mortality: a meta-analytic review. *Perspectives on Psychological Science*, 10(2), pp.227–237.
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- World Bank (2024). *Population data: Portugal*. Washington, DC: World Bank. Available at: <https://data.worldbank.org/indicator/SP.POP.TOTL?locations=PT> [Accessed 5 April 2026].

13.2 Document History

Version	Date	Changes	Author
v1.0	May 2026	Initial draft - Phase 1 MVP scope	Filipa Martins